

# module-13-indic-ecology - Darshana (60-min workshop)

IKS Curriculum - middle band

## Module 13 — Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Darśana)

**Sanskrit:** *Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam* · **Band:** Middle (6-8) · **Duration:** 60 min · **Path:** Darśana (Workshop)

“The world is one family” — Indian ecological frameworks.

**Darśana note.** This workshop condenses Module 13’s full 10-day arc into one hour. For the deeper version — daily lesson plans, quizzes, assessments, slide decks — switch to [Adhyayana](#) (the Full Course path).

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### Opening hook · 5 min

Project the verse: “*vasudhaiva kuṭumbakam*” — “*the Earth itself is one family.*” (Mahā Upaniṣad 6.71-73.) “*This is the framework. Today we look at the practices — sacred groves, yajña, ahimsā — that came from it.*”

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### Core idea · 15 min

#### Indic ecology framework:

1. **Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam** (Mahā Upaniṣad 6.71-73): the Earth is one family. Universal moral inclusion.
2. **Sacred groves (devarakāḍu, sarpa-kāvu):** community-protected forests, ~13,000 documented across India. Biodiversity hotspots, water-table protection.
3. **Yajña (Bhagavad Gītā 3.10-14):** the ecological cycle — every taking is part of a give-and-take with the larger system.
4. **Ahimsā:** non-harming, extended to non-human life.
5. **Five elements (pañcabhūta):** ecological substrate — air, water, fire, earth, space. Pollution = imbalance.

**Climate context:** these are frameworks. Practice was uneven. Don’t romanticise.

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## Demonstration · 10 min

**Local sacred-grove research.** Pairs research one named sacred grove (e.g., Mawphlang in Meghalaya, Sarguja in Chhattisgarh, Karnataka coast devarakāḍu). 5 minutes. Quick presentation.

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## Source moment · 5 min

Paraphrase Mahā Upaniṣad 6.71-73: *“The narrow-minded ask ‘is this mine or yours?’ For the noble-minded, the whole Earth is one family.”*

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## Hands-on activity · 15 min

**Local environmental project pitch.** Pairs design one local environmental action: tree planting, river cleanup, school waste reduction. Present.

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## Reflection + take-home · 10 min

*“Which Indic framework most surprises you? Which would you adapt to your daily life?”*

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## Go deeper into Adhyayana

The 10 days you’re skipping if you only do this workshop:

- **Day 01** — Vasudhaiva kuṭumbakam — the founding verse
- **Day 02** — Five elements as ecological frame
- **Day 03** — Rivers as sacred
- **Day 04** — Sacred groves
- **Day 05** — Yajña cycle — Gītā 3.10-14
- **Day 06** — Pṛthivī Sūkta — Atharva Veda 12.1
- **Day 07** — Iṣopaniṣad mantra 1
- **Day 08** — Climate change context
- **Day 09** — From ancient to action
- **Day 10** — Project pitch + assessment

→ [Open the Adhyayana track for this module](#) to access all 10 days, the 4-audience PDFs, the slide deck, the quizzes, and the project rubric.